geographical ambit of the region. However pleasing Admiral Harris' description of the Indo-Pacific as extending from "Hollywood to Bollywood" may be to Indian ears, the fact remains that the Indian conception of the region extends to the eastern seaboard of Africa.[33] Nevertheless, it may be argued that China's growing naval presence in this part of the Indian Ocean, including its access to the Gwadar port located close to the Persian Gulf and its naval base in Djibouti at the entrance to the Red Sea, as well as India's thickening ties with Israel and the Gulf monarchies, are likely to narrow India–US divergence over the affairs of this region in coming years. Further, as evidenced by India stopping oil purchases from Iran after the Trump administration imposed fresh sanctions, as well as by the Trump administration's grant of an exemption to India's continued involvement in the Chabahar port project in Iran, India and the United States could also choose to accommodate each other's core interests and policy objectives.[34]

Notwithstanding the growing convergence as well as the irritants that may persist in the India–US relationship, the future depth and breadth of cooperation between them will be shaped by a number of challenges within the Indo-Pacific region. Because Asia has not seen a major conflict since the border war between China and Vietnam in 1979, it is tempting to embrace the notion that the peace lasting for the last four decades will continue into the future. However, the pathway to Asian security is full of potholes. West Asia and the Persian Gulf, connected to Asian security in significant ways, are in a greater state of turmoil than at any time since the dissolution of the Ottoman Empire a century ago. The unravelling of West Asia, which started with Iraq's invasion of Kuwait and continued with the 2003 US invasion of Iraq, has accelerated since 2011.[35] The situation in Syria continues to be serious. Moreover, there is possible unravelling of the Af-Pak region, where Afghanistan's security is seriously compromised by the support, sustenance, and